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General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

Important Committees

Important Committees

Committees and commissions are formed to study a problem or issue and then make recommendations to resolve the issue. The government can either accept or reject the findings/recommendations of the committee.

Economic Reforms

Committee Name	Chairman	Year	Purpose
Narasimham Committee	M. Narasimham	1991	Recommended financial sector reforms, leading to the establishment of new private sector banks.
Raja Chelliah Committee	Raja Chelliah	1991	Tax reforms in India.
Kelkar Committee	Vijay Kelkar	2015	Assessing Public-Private Partnerships (PPP) in India and tax structure reforms.
Raghuram Rajan Committee	Raghuram Rajan	2008	Recommended reforms to strengthen India's financial sector.
Tarapore Committee	S.S. Tarapore	1997	Recommendations on capital account convertibility.
Vijay Kelkar Committee	Vijay Kelkar	2015	Formulated a framework for Public-Private Partnerships (PPP) in India.
Bimal Jalan Committee	Bimal Jalan	1996	Report on the working of capital market infrastructure institutions (MIIs).
Rangarajan Committee	C. Rangarajan	1998	Computerization of the banking industry and public sector disinvestment.
Suresh Tendulkar Committee	Suresh Tendulkar	2005	Reviewed the methodology for estimating poverty in India.

Vohra Committee	Vohra	1993	Investigated the criminal-politician nexus in India.
Rajiv Mehrishi Committee	Rajiv Mehrishi	2020	Measured the impact of waiving interest and COVID-19-related moratoriums.
P.J. Nayak Committee	P.J. Nayak	2014	Examined governance in public sector banks.
R. V. Gupta Committee	R.V. Gupta	1998	Recommended power sector reforms.
Abid Hussain Committee	Abid Hussain	1980	Examined the functioning of the Public Distribution System (PDS) in India.
Madhava Rao Committee	Madhava Rao	2003	Suggested measures for reducing the revenue deficit of states.
N. Malhotra Committee	N. Malhotra	1994	Suggested reforms in the insurance sector leading to the establishment of IRDA.
Y.B. Reddy Committee	Y.B. Reddy	2009	Assessed the stability and efficiency of the financial sector.
Rajendra Sachar Committee	Rajendra Sachar	2006	Studied the socio-economic and educational status of Muslims in India.
Abhijeet Sen Committee	Abhijeet Sen	2006	Formulated food policy in the long term.
Pradip Shah Committee	Pradip Shah	2015	Developed international retail business at the International Financial Services Centre (IFSC).
P.K. Mohanty Committee	P.K. Mohanty	2020	Reviewed ownership guidelines for Indian Private Sector Banks.

M.K. Kamath Committee	M.K. Kamath	2014	Setting parameters for loan restructuring.

Social Reforms

Committee Name	Chairman	Year	Purpose
Mandal Commission	B.P. Mandal	1979	Examined the social and economic backwardness of castes and communities, recommending quotas in public services.
Justice Verma Committee	Justice J.S. Verma	2012	Recommended amendments to criminal laws to enhance punishment for sexual offences.
Justice Verma Committee	Justice Verma	2013	Recommended amendments to criminal laws after the Delhi gang rape case.
Ranganath Mishra Commission	Ranganath Mishra	2007	Recommended measures for the upliftment of socially and educationally backward classes among religious and linguistic minorities.
Ashok Mehta Committee	Ashok Mehta	1977	Recommended the establishment of a three-tier Panchayati Raj system.
Rajinder Sachar Committee	Rajinder Sachar	2006	Studied the socio-economic and educational status of Muslims in India.
Kothari Commission	D. S. Kothari	1964	Examined all aspects of the educational sector in India.
Madhava Menon Committee	Madhava Menon	2007	Recommended reforms in legal education and the legal profession in India.
Shah Commission	Justice R. S. Shah	1977	Inquired into excesses committed during the Emergency and recommended actions against those responsible.

Suresh Tendulkar Committee	Suresh Tendulkar	2005	Reviewed the methodology for estimating poverty in India.
Ashok Desai Committee	Ashok Desai	2000	Formulated recommendations on competition policy in India.
Kasturirangan Committee	K. Kasturirangan	2017	Formulated the National Education Policy 2020.
Rajwade Committee	Rajwade	1997	Reviewed the forex management policies in India.
Shyam Benegal Committee	Shyam Benegal	2016	Suggested reforms in the functioning of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC).
P.V. Rajamannar Committee	P.V. Rajamannar	1987	Examined the demand for a separate Telangana state.
Sarkaria Commission	R.S. Sarkaria	1983	Examined the relationship between the Center and States and suggested measures to improve federalism.
M.M. Punchhi Commission	M.M. Punchhi	2007	Reviewed the working of the Constitution regarding the Center-State relations and suggested reforms.
P.J. Nayak Committee	P.J. Nayak	2014	Examined issues related to governance in public sector banks.
Khusro Committee	Khusro	1980	Reforms in the agricultural credit system.

Political and Administrative Reforms

Committee Name	Chairman	Year	Purpose
NITI Aayog	NITI Aayog	2015	Focuses on cooperative federalism, sustainable development goals, and fostering innovation.

Lodha Committee	Justice R.M. Lodha	2015	Reforms in the BCCI following the IPL spot-fixing and betting scandal.
Arvind Mayaram Committee	Arvind Mayaram	2013	Reviewed and suggested changes in the definition of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI).
P.K. Mohanty Committee	P.K. Mohanty	2020	Review of corporate structure for Indian Private Sector Banks.
Venkataswami Commission	Venkataswami	1996	Investigated the securities scam in the Indian stock market.
Sarkaria Commission	R.S. Sarkaria	1983	Examined the relationship between the Center and States, suggesting measures to improve federalism.
Vohra Committee	Vohra	1993	Investigated the criminal-politician nexus in India.
Subbarao Committee on Small Savings	Subbarao	2007	Suggested measures to revamp the small savings scheme.
B.N. Srikrishna Committee	B.N. Srikrishna	2010	Examined the demand for a separate Telangana state and recommended measures to address the issue.
Rajendra Sachar Committee	Rajendra Sachar	2006	Studied the socio-economic and educational status of Muslims in India.

Environment-Related Committees

Committee Name	Chairman	Year	Purpose
One-Man Committee to Prevent Stubble Burning	Justice Madan B. Lokur	2020	To take steps to prevent stubble burning in Punjab, Haryana, and Uttar Pradesh, which contributes to pollution in the Delhi-NCR region.
Raghunath Anant Mashelkar Panel	Raghunath Anant Mashelkar	2014	Suggested the best technologies for the Swachh Bharat Abhiyaan to improve sanitation and cleanliness.

Bhurelal Committee	Bhurelal	2014	Focused on recommending measures for increasing motor vehicle tax to tackle environmental pollution in Delhi.
Kasturirangan Committee	K. Kasturirangan	2017	Drafted the National Education Policy, which includes a focus on environmental sustainability in education.
Ramesh Chand Committee	Ramesh Chand	2020	Recommended linking of sugarcane prices to sugar rates to stabilize the financial state of the sugarcane industry, indirectly helping environmental sustainability in the sector.
R. V. Gupta Committee	R.V. Gupta	1998	Recommended power sector reforms, which include the promotion of renewable energy sources and energy efficiency.
Abid Hussain Committee	Abid Hussain	1980	Examined the functioning of the Public Distribution System (PDS) and proposed reforms to enhance food security and environmental sustainability in agricultural practices.
Rajendra Sachar Committee	Rajendra Sachar	2006	Studied the socio-economic status of Muslims in India and recommended policies indirectly addressing environmental equity through development.

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Goswami Committee	Goswami	1993	Studied Assam's economic situation and recommended measures for sustainable development, indirectly tackling environmental issues in the region.
Vijay Kelkar Committee	Vijay Kelkar	2015	Formulated a framework for Public-Private Partnerships (PPP) that includes sustainable infrastructure development with an emphasis on reducing the environmental footprint.
P.K. Mohanty Committee	P.K. Mohanty	2020	Reviewed corporate structure for Indian Private Sector Banks with a focus on promoting eco-friendly investments.